

John Lourenco - Engineering Manager

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PROFILE

Engineering Manager with 14+ years in software quality and 8+ years leading engineering teams, including proven manager-of-managers experience. Led distributed teams through company's growth from £4M to £25M revenue. Instrumental in introducing and maintaining LRQA certificated ISO 9001 and ISO 27001. Transformed 4-month manual testing bottleneck into 2-day automated release validation across 90 VMs and 12 performance machines, reducing internal release defects by 90%. Built and scaled high-performing teams across continents with 100% UK retention.

Ensuring that engineering and stakeholders share the same clear vision, removing blockers, hiring smart people, and guiding them through onboarding to make them feel part of the team and set them up for success.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership & Strategy

- Manager of Managers, Team Scaling (up and down), Strategic Planning, Stakeholder Management
- Budget Stewardship (£175k+), Cross-functional Partnership managing, Vendor Management

Testing & Quality

- Test Strategy, Test Plan, Final Test Reports, Release Strategy, Test & Release Management
- Go/No-Go Governance, Release Planning & Scheduling, Bug tracking and prioritization
- Business Test Data Management, Risk & Issue Management

Technical Excellence

- **Development and Automation:** Python, C++, TypeScript, Shell/Bash, PowerShell, Code review, JavaScript, Squish, Selenium WebDriver, Performance Testing, BDD/TDD, Page Object
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** Jenkins, GitHub/GitLab, Docker, AWS
- **Collaboration Tools:** Jira (Zephyr, X-Ray), Confluence, Agile/Scrum
- **Innovation:** ML/AI on test automation, and product help, logging analysis, Anomaly detection

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Implemented and owned core engineering processes including SDLC, Security, Test and Release Strategies, Test Plans, enabling predictable quarterly releases
- Led end-to-end release management including planning, scheduling, deployment coordination, and post-release verification as engineering go/no-go decision maker
- Reduced release defects by 90% and customer tickets by 50%, achieving zero escalations during 6x revenue growth
- Transformed a 4-month chaotic manual regression to 2-day automated validation across 90+ VMs and performance machines. Architected and managed entire development infrastructure.
- Led and built test automation frameworks from scratch using Python, and Selenium WebDriver and TypeScript
- Zero compliance failures across 5+ years of external audits (ISO 9001/27001)
- Improved customer retention from 40% to 85%+ through pushing left a quality-first approach and engaging teams to embrace quality and enabling testers to have a stronger voice
- Successfully operated as manager of managers for 3 years with 16-person organization
- Led transformation from unproductive waterfall methodology to agile improving sprint predictability by 60% and team ownership with a regular cadence and burndowns going down with demos at the end of each sprint
- Reduced CI/CD build times from 3 days to 6 hours through pipeline optimization and parallelization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Perforce Software (formerly Programming Research) | London, UK
Engineering Manager in Test | June 2017 - September 2025

Led teams for Perforce/Helix QAC static analysis product serving safety-critical customers in automotive, aerospace, and defence. Maintained zero audit findings for 5+ consecutive years (ISO 9001, ISO 27001) while scaling organization during 6x revenue growth.

Leadership & Transformation

- Scaled and led the team from 4 to 16 engineers, including 2 Engineering Managers reporting directly
- Led agile transformation reducing silos, improving communication and team ownership
- Implemented shift-left testing approach with development collaboration
- Partnered with Product, SecOps, RevOps, VP levels to achieve clear and agree outcomes, such as vision, customer immediate needs
- Stewarded £175k+ annual operational expenses with 20% vendor cost reduction
- Achieved 100% UK retention, and 3-year average tenure in India
- Identified early market risks from Chinese competition, providing early vision and warnings

Test & Release Management

- Created and owned Test Strategy and Release Strategy for quarterly releases, defining scope, environments, entry/exit criteria, and rollback procedures
- Planned and scheduled all test activities including system, regression, performance, and business scenario testing
- Led end-to-end release management with final go/no-go decision authority for every release
- Owned business test packs and end-to-end user workflows, ensuring comprehensive test coverage
- Implemented risk-based testing approach and mocking strategies for complex dependency management
- Achieved 40% AWS cost reduction through resource optimization and strategic hybrid cloud decisions

Automation & Framework Development

- Built comprehensive test automation frameworks from scratch using Python and TypeScript
- Implemented Selenium WebDriver for web automation and GUI testing with Squish framework
- Delivered a multi-customer, SaaS-like hosted instance of Helix QAC Dashboard, providing browser-based access to analysis snapshots and compliance trends
- Established Jenkins CI/CD pipelines with GitHub integration, adopted across 50+ engineers
- Created API and System test automation validation and performance benchmarking
- Extended automation to internal communication layers and performance testing
- Drove ML/AI adoption for log analysis and failure detection, reducing bug triage time by 40%

Operational Excellence

- Improved sprint predictability by 60% through metric-driven planning and team ownership
- Reduced AWS costs by 40% through strategic on-premises decisions
- Co-led Jira/GitHub integration standards and X-Ray test management
- Established engineering standards and practices adopted organization-wide
- Created test data management framework for consistent test execution

QA Analyst to Team Lead | Perforce Software | 2013 - 2017

- Progressed from IC to Team Lead, creating Python test framework still in production
- Built foundation for product's test automation strategy

Previous Roles

Verification & Validation Engineer | Critical Software Tec. | 2011 - 2013

- Delivered V&V for aerospace/defence under DO-178B/DO-229D standards
- Achieved 100% code coverage for GE Aviation safety-critical systems

Software Developer Intern | Critical Software | 2009 - 2011

- Developed JavaScript / ExtJS front-end and maintained test automation

University Lecturer | ISCAC, Coimbra | 2009 - 2011

- Selected to teach Informatics Applications based on academic excellence

EDUCATION & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

- Bachelor in IT Management | ISCAC, Coimbra | 2007-2009 | Top Graduate
- Bachelor of Business Informatics | ISCAC, Coimbra | 2003-2007

LANGUAGES - English (Fluent), Portuguese (Native), Spanish (Conversational)